



A HALF-HOUR COMEDY SERIES

Recurring

The only thing harder than making it in Hollywood is figuring out
which version of you made it.

CREATED BY • JOSH BANDAY • HALF-HOUR • SINGLE CAMERA • COMEDY

SCROLL

THE LOGLINE

A perpetually agreeable actor clings to his *recurring guest role* on a hit streaming show — saying yes to every favor, every bad idea, every person who needs him — while secretly writing a pilot about the very show that *might fire him any week*.

"Atlanta" meets "Hacks" — a surreal Hollywood comedy about the most lovable liar on the lot. Think the workplace specificity of "Abbott Elementary" with the identity crisis of "Barry."

THE CREATOR



PHOTOGRAPH BY PAMELA LUTKIN

Josh Banday

WRITER • ACTOR • DIRECTOR

Josh Banday is a working television actor who has spent years delivering other people's lines with impeccable timing. Now he's writing his own. A **Second City** and **Groundlings** alum, Josh brings the structural precision of a seasoned improviser and the on-set fluency of an actor who has lived inside the machine he's now writing about.

Born **Black, Filipino, Mexican, and Jewish**, and raised in the **LGBTQ+ community**, Josh writes "Code-Switching Comedy" — stories that explore the specific, hilarious friction of belonging everywhere and nowhere. He is currently developing two comedy pilots and an animated feature.

Upload
AMAZON PRIME VIDEO

Not Dead Yet
ABC

Second City
IMPROV TRAINING

Groundlings
IMPROV TRAINING

Three reasons this show sells *now*.

Post-Representation Hangover

01

Audiences — especially the ones "diverse content" was made for — are tired of inclusion theater. They want specificity over tokenism. This show doesn't represent diversity; it satirizes the industry's relationship to it.

The Creator Economy Gap

02

Everyone is a creator now. The line between "day job" and "creative dream" has never been blurrier. No comedy is currently making that cognitive dissonance funny. *Atlanta* did it for music. This does it for Hollywood itself.

The Set-Tested Creator

03

Josh doesn't write about Hollywood from the outside. He writes from the makeup chair, the shared trailer, the craft services table. This is insider comedy from someone still inside — not a memoir, a dispatch.

Sunset Gower Studios

80-90% of the show takes place on a single studio lot — the soundstage of a fictional streaming comedy called *Roommates*. The lot is a small city with its own class system, politics, and unwritten rules. Jules lives here. He just doesn't belong.



Stage 7

THE PERFORMANCE

The soundstage. Where Jules is most competent and most fraudulent. He delivers other people's lines perfectly — then steals moments to write his own on his phone between takes.



Craft Services

THE BARGAINING FLOOR

Every conversation at craft is a transaction. Careers are built over bad coffee. Jules agrees to mutually exclusive lunch plans here three times a week.



Trailer Village

THE HIERARCHY

Your trailer size equals your worth. Jules shares "the hallway trailer" with five other recurring actors — a soap star, a stage mom, an influencer, a mute stuntman, and a British actor who won't stop talking.



The Writers' Room

THE HOLY OF HOLIES

Building C, 3rd Floor. The room Jules isn't invited to. He lingers near it, befriends the writers' assistant for intel, and secretly uses overheard conversations in his own pilot.



The Parking Lot

THE TRUTH

You can't perform here. This is where real conversations happen — phone calls with his agent, breakdowns after bad takes, and his ex from post-production parked three spaces over.



Production Offices

THE MACHINE

Where decisions about Jules's fate are made without him. He's always "checking in" about next week's call time. They're always "still figuring it out."



JOSH BANDA AS JULES

Julian "Jules" Santos

34 • RECURRING GUEST ACTOR • THE MOST LOVABLE LIAR ON THE LOT

YES-AND REFLEX

UNCONSCIOUS MIRROR

SECRET WRITER

Black-Filipino-Mexican-Jewish-Queer. Second City and Groundlings trained. Jules has spent his entire career being the perfect chameleon — the guy who reads every room and becomes what it needs. His improv training rewired his brain: he physically cannot say no. He mirrors whoever he's with without realizing it. Everyone loves him. Nobody knows him. Including himself.

"I've performed 'likable' so many times I forgot what I actually sound like."

IF NOT JOSH



JABOUKIE YOUNG-WHITE
THE DAILY SHOW • ONLY MURDERS



JEREMY POPE
HOLLYWOOD • THE INSPECTION

Marla Feld

42. Failed comedy writer turned talent agent who channels all her creative anxiety into optimizing other people's careers. Dresses like she's negotiating a hostage situation. Eats food she hates because it's "efficient." Weaponizes Jules's yes-and reflex without realizing it — pitches opportunities in escalating panic until he agrees just to calm her down.

"I RAN THE NUMBERS. Twice. Four times at 2 AM while crying in my car. The math is GOOD, Jules."

CASTING COMPS



JUNE DIANE RAPHAEL
GRACE AND FRANKIE



CASEY WILSON
HAPPY ENDINGS

Scotty Yuen

38. Golden retriever energy in athleisure. Youngest of five siblings who survived by being the agreeable one. Validates every feeling Jules has, which sounds supportive but actually prevents him from growing. When Jules spirals, Scotty spirals harder. Always manifesting something in the background — lighting candles, pulling oracle cards mid-crisis.

"I'm hearing resistance, and that resistance is INFORMATION. Also maybe your body is wrong? Let's honor the fear. But also maybe do it anyway?"

CASTING COMPS



MANNY JACINTO
THE GOOD PLACE



BOWEN YANG
SATURDAY NIGHT LIVE

Dominique "Dom" Hall

33. Black, queer, Yale MFA grad. Writes searing drama while Jules writes crowd-pleasing comedy. She thinks he's wasting his intelligence on likability. The only person who sees through his mirror — and refuses to let him hide behind charm.

"You write like you're apologizing for taking up space. Stop it."

CASTING COMPS



JASMINE CEPHAS JONES
HAMILTON • BLINDSPOTTING



AYO EDEBIRI
THE BEAR

Marco Santos

28. Proudly Mexican, aggressively authentic, works in construction, has never code-switched a day in his life. Thinks Jules's Hollywood career is embarrassing. Represents the version of Jules that never learned to perform — which makes Jules feel like a fraud every time they're in the same room.

"You play a gay guy on TV but won't bring a date to Mom's house. That's some real Hollywood shit."

CASTING COMPS



XOLO MARIDUEÑA
COBRA KAI



DIEGO TINOCO
ON MY BLOCK

The Yes-And

Jules's improv training broke his ability to say no. Combined with unconscious mirroring, he becomes whoever the room needs — and loses himself in the process. He doesn't know he does this. Everyone else does.

SUPERPOWER

- Everyone on the lot loves him — he's the perfect scene partner, the perfect listener, the perfect friend
- He ends up in extraordinary situations that fuel his writing
- His adaptability makes him indispensable on set
- He can talk to anyone, fit anywhere, charm everyone

WEAKNESS

- He's overcommitted to 14 things and lying to 6 people at all times
- His romantic relationships collapse because partners realize they fell in love with a performance
- His agent and manager exploit the reflex without knowing it
- He says yes to career-killing jobs because he can't say no

The Episode Engine

1

THE SETUP

Jules is barely holding onto his spot on Roommates

2

THE YES

Someone asks for something unreasonable. Jules agrees instantly.

3

THE STACK

He says yes to 2-3 more incompatible things

4

THE COLLISION

All commitments happen simultaneously on the lot

5

THE COST

He survives — but his secret pilot gets better because the chaos was great material

The first four minutes of the pilot. Jules delivers someone else's joke, says yes to three things he shouldn't, and writes a line that changes everything.

INT. SOUNDSTAGE — "ROOMMATES" SET — DAY

We open MID-SCENE on the set of ROOMMATES — a glossy, well-lit streaming sitcom. JULES SANTOS (34, effortlessly charming) stands beside MADISON COLE (40s, the star, blonde, impossibly confident). They're mid-take.

JULES

(perfectly timed)

Well, maybe if you stopped dating guys who think "emotional availability" is a Netflix password, you wouldn't have this problem!

The CREW laughs. Madison reacts, flawless.

DIRECTOR (O.S.)

Cut! Great, Madison. Really vulnerable.

Madison beams. Jules waits for notes. He doesn't get any.

MADISON

(to Jules, not looking at him)

Can you grab me a sparkling water? The Italian one. Not the French one.

JULES

(instant, warm)

Yeah, of course! I got you.

She walks off without acknowledgment. Jules pulls out his phone. Types furiously.

PILOT — "CODE-SWITCHING" — Scene 3

"I'm more of a 'pray to a white Jesus in Filipino while my tia burns sage and my stepdad argues with the rabbi on FaceTime' kind of guy."

INT. CRAFT SERVICES — CONTINUOUS

Jules grabs the Italian sparkling water. DAMON (30s, harried PA) rushes up.

DAMON

Dude, thank GOD. We need someone to read opposite Madison for coverage. Cameron called out sick.

Jules looks at his phone — he was in the zone.

JULES

(mirroring Damon's frantic energy)

Oh man, yeah, totally. When?

DAMON

Like... now?

JULES

(big smile)

Yeah, no, I'm free. Let's do it.

INT. WRITERS' ROOM — LATER

Jules enters. BECCA, the writers' assistant, brought him here. Four WRITERS sit around a table. The SHOWRUNNER (50s) looks up.

SHOWRUNNER

You're the guy from set, right?

JULES

(matching the room's vibe — chill, self-deprecating)

Yeah. Jules. Becca said you needed some alts?

He pitches two jokes. The room LAUGHS. The showrunner types them immediately.

SHOWRUNNER

You ever think about writing on this show?

Jules freezes. The dream question. Beat.

JULES

(sincere)

I mean... yeah. That'd be amazing.

SHOWRUNNER

(already back to typing)

Cool. Oh — one more thing. You free tomorrow at 6 AM? Reshooting the diner scene.

6 AM is Jules's only writing time. He doesn't hesitate.

JULES

Yeah! I'm there.

INT. HALLWAY — CONTINUOUS

Jules pulls out his phone. Opens his calendar. The 6 AM block reads: "WRITE — DO NOT MOVE."

He deletes the block. Types:

"Jules stares at his phone. He just said yes to the thing that will keep him from being a writer. He doesn't know how to stop."

FADE TO BLACK.

END OF COLD OPEN

8 Episodes. One Question:

Can you stop performing long enough to become yourself?

01 "Call Time"

WORKPLACE COMEDY

Jules books his sixth episode of Roommates and celebrates by saying yes to three things happening the same day: directing a friend's short, dog-sitting for a series regular, and helping a PA move. A dog escapes on set. A couch ends up in the wrong trailer. He survives — then overhears the showrunner say "we might write him out."

02 "The Hallway Trailer"

BOTTLE EPISODE

Entire episode in the shared trailer Jules occupies with five other recurring actors. A network executive is touring the lot — Jules tries to make the trailer seem "fun and collaborative" by mediating every conflict. The British actor catches him using different accents with each person. The stuntman finally speaks: "You don't have a personality, do you?"

03 "The Call Sheet"

ROMANTIC COMEDY

Jules matches with Simone, a sound mixer on Roommates who's never noticed him. Their date goes perfectly because he mirrors her energy. The next day she watches him be a completely different person with his scene partner. She thinks the whole date was an act. He doesn't understand what went wrong.

04 "Punch-Up"

CAREER DISASTER

Jules gives notes on a bad script. The showrunner loves them. Now the writers' room thinks he's trying to take their jobs. Invited to a "casual room hang," he mirrors every writer's energy and pitches six contradictory takes. The head writer bans him from the room forever. His reputation: "the actor who thinks he's a writer."

05 "The Showcase"

FAMILY EPISODE

Jules's mom visits the lot. She's a former theater actress who thinks TV is selling out. She watches him be three different people in three hours. She pulls him aside: "Who are you when nobody's watching?" He has no answer. That night he writes the best scene in his pilot.

06 "HODL My Heart"

THE YES-AND CATASTROPHE

Marla pitches Jules a hosting gig on a crypto dating show. Scotty validates his hesitation, then validates the agent. Jules yes-ands his way into accepting. He discovers the show is a meme on Reddit. Meanwhile, his secret pilot gets leaked to someone at the network.

07 "The Room Where It Happens"

ESPIONAGE COMEDY

Jules's agent submits his pilot to the same network that makes Roommates. The pilot is about a recurring guest actor on a fictional show — and the showrunner reads it. Jules spends the entire episode trying to manage the fallout while being asked to help punch up scripts "for free, because you're so good at this."

08 "Recurring"

SEASON FINALE

Jules gets fired from Roommates. But his pilot gets picked up. The final scene: he walks onto the lot for the first time as a creator, not an actor. He passes his old shared trailer. He reaches the door of a writers' room — his writers' room. Someone on the lot recognizes him and asks for a favor. He opens his mouth to say "yeah, totally" — and the screen cuts to black.

Three homes. One perfect fit.

FX

"The next chapter in FX's auteur comedy legacy."

FX built the "specific is universal" brand with Atlanta, Reservation Dogs, and What We Do in the Shadows. A show about becoming an auteur — on a network that champions auteurs — is inception-level brand alignment. John Landgraf would see this as the next evolution.

Slate Comps: Atlanta • Reservation Dogs • The Bear • What We Do in the Shadows

HBO

"The multi-hyphenate creator deal they've been looking for."

HBO wants comedy that feels like prestige TV. They love writer-actor-comedian packages (Issa Rae, Donald Glover). Josh is that package. This delivers status anxiety, Hollywood satire, and emotional depth in a format they can build a franchise around.

Slate Comps: Insecure • Industry • Somebody Somewhere • Hacks (Max)

Hulu

"Smart enough for discovery, specific enough for loyalty."

Hulu lives in the sweet spot between HBO prestige and network accessibility. Their comedy slate skews young, diverse, and streaming-first. This is the show FOR underrepresented audiences that isn't ABOUT being underrepresented.

Slate Comps: Ramy • Only Murders in the Building • PEN15 • Shrill

He's been the B-plot long enough.

*We're seeking a network partner for an 8-episode first season.
Full pilot script, series bible, and lookbook available upon request.*

JOSH BANDAY | WRITER • ACTOR • DIRECTOR

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